



Programming Fundamentals

Conditional Statements

Programming Fundamentals Team

SETU

2026-06-18



Outline

1. Flow of Control in a Program
2. Boolean Conditions
3. Relational Operators
4. Conditional Statement - if statement
5. Common Syntax Errors



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1. Flow of Control in a Program

Each program you write will typically have:



1. Flow of Control in a Program

Each program you write will typically have:

Sequence	Things that will be done in a particular order
Selection	Things that will be done conditionally
Iteration	Things that will be done repetitively



1. Flow of Control in a Program

For this slide deck, we will be covering the first two types of control flow: sequence and selection. We will cover iteration in a later slide deck.



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1. Flow of Control in a Program

For this slide deck, we will be covering the first two types of control flow: sequence and selection. We will cover iteration in a later slide deck.

Sequence	Things that will be done in a particular order
Selection	Things that will be done conditionally
Iteration	Things that will be done repetitively

Sequence is the default flow of control in a program. It simply means that the statements in a program will be executed in the order they are written.



1. Flow of Control in a Program

Sequence	Things that will be done in a particular order
Selection	Things that will be done conditionally
Iteration	Things that will be done repetitively



1. Flow of Control in a Program

Sequence	Things that will be done in a particular order
Selection	Things that will be done conditionally
Iteration	Things that will be done repetitively

- For the rest of this slide deck, we will be covering selection statements.
- Selection statements allow us to execute certain statements only if a certain condition is true.
- The most common selection statement is the if statement.



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2.1 Data types - Boolean

```
test10.py > ...
1  isOpen = True
2  isClosed = False
3
4  print('Is the shop open? ' + str(isOpen))
5  print('Is the shop closed? ' + str(isClosed))

PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS
maireadmeagher@Mac dev % /opt/homebrew/bin/python3 /Users/maireadmeagher/Docu
Is the shop open? True
Is the shop closed? False
maireadmeagher@Mac dev %
```

- Remember our discussion of data types? We will be using the data type called **Boolean** in selection statements.
- A **Boolean** is a data type that can only have two values: True or False.



2.1 Data types - Boolean

```
test10.py > ...
1  isOpen = True
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3
4  print('Is the shop open? ' + str(isOpen))
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PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS
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Is the shop open? True
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maireadmeagher@Mac dev %
```

- Remember our discussion of data types? We will be using the data type called **Boolean** in selection statements.
- A **Boolean** is a data type that can only have two values: True or False.
- Booleans are often used in programming to represent the truth value of a condition or to control the flow of a program based on certain conditions.



2.2 Boolean Conditions

- A Boolean condition is an expression that evaluates to either **True** or **False** e.g.

```
x < 50  
number > 0
```




2.2 Boolean Conditions

- A Boolean condition is an expression that evaluates to either **True** or **False** e.g.

```
x < 50  
number > 0
```

- A conditional statement evaluates a Boolean condition and its result will determine which section of the code is executed.



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3. Relational Operators

Operator	Syntax	Returns true if...
>	x > y	x is greater than y
>=	x >= y	x is greater than or equal to y
<	x < y	x is less than y
<=	x <= y	x is less than or equal to y
==	x == y	x and y are equal
!=	x != y	x and y are not equal



3. Relational Operators

Operator	Syntax	Returns true if...
>	x > y	x is greater than y
>=	x >= y	x is greater than or equal to y
<	x < y	x is less than y
<=	x <= y	x is less than or equal to y
==	x == y	x and y are equal
!=	x != y	x and y are not equal

= is an assignment operator and doesn't test for equality.
== is used to test for equality.



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4.1 if statement syntax

`if` *perform some boolean test* :

Do these statement(s) if the test is true

← actions if
condition is true



4.1 if statement syntax

`if` *perform some boolean test* :

Do these statement(s) if the test is true

← actions if
condition is true

NOTE:

- Python relies on indentation to define scope in the code.
- Indentation is a whitespace at the beginning of the line.
- We saw this earlier when writing functions.



4.1 if statement syntax

Example of an if statement:

```
age = 25
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
    print("You can vote.")
```




4.1 if statement syntax

Example of an if statement:

```
age = 25
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
    print("You can vote.")
```

This will output:

```
You are an adult.
You can vote.
```



4.1 if statement syntax

Example of a sequence of if statements:

```
age = 18
if age > 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
    print("And you are over eighteen")

if age == 18:
    print("Congratulations on reaching
adulthood!")

if age < 18:
    print("You are a minor.")
```



4.1 if statement syntax

Example of a sequence of if statements:

```
age = 18
if age > 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
    print("And you are over eighteen")

if age == 18:
    print("Congratulations on reaching
adulthood!")

if age < 18:
    print("You are a minor.")
```

This will output:

```
Congratulations on reaching adulthood!
```



4.2 if-else statement syntax

if *perform some boolean test* :

*Do these statement(s) if the test
is true*

← actions if condition is **true**

else:

*Do these statement(s) if the test
is false*

← actions if condition is **false**



4.2 if-else statement syntax

if *perform some boolean test* :

*Do these statement(s) if the test
is true*

← actions if condition is **true**

else:

*Do these statement(s) if the test
is false*

← actions if condition is **false**

The else clause has **no condition** — it runs whenever the if condition is false. Only one branch (either if or else) will execute.



4.2 if-else statement syntax

Returning to the age example — we had two separate if statements:

```
# Two separate if statements
age = 20
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
if age < 18:
    print("You are a minor.")
```



4.2 if-else statement syntax

Returning to the age example — we had two separate if statements:

```
# Two separate if statements
age = 20
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
if age < 18:
    print("You are a minor.")
```

Simplified with if-else

```
# Simplified with if-else
age = 20
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
else:
    print("You are a minor.")
```



4.2 if-else statement syntax

Returning to the age example — we had two separate if statements:

```
# Two separate if statements
age = 20
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
if age < 18:
    print("You are a minor.")
```

Simplified with if-else

```
# Simplified with if-else
age = 20
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
else:
    print("You are a minor.")
```

- The if-else version is cleaner — there are only two outcomes, so else handles the second case directly.



4.2 if-else statement syntax

A fresh example with if-else:

```
temperature = 22

if temperature > 25:
    print("It is warm outside.")
    print("Wear light clothing.")
else:
    print("It is cool outside.")
    print("Bring a jacket.")
```



4.2 if-else statement syntax

A fresh example with if-else:

```
temperature = 22

if temperature > 25:
    print("It is warm outside.")
    print("Wear light clothing.")
else:
    print("It is cool outside.")
    print("Bring a jacket.")
```

This will output:

```
It is cool outside.
Bring a jacket.
```



4.3 if-elif-else statement syntax

if `condition1` :

statements if condition1 is true

elif `condition2` :

statements if condition1 false AND condition2 true

else:

statements if both conditions are false



4.3 if-elif-else statement syntax

if `condition1` :

statements if condition1 is true

elif `condition2` :

statements if condition1 false AND condition2 true

else:

statements if both conditions are false

You can have as many `elif` clauses as you need. Only the **first** matching branch executes — the rest are skipped.



4.3 if-elif-else statement syntax

Example using if-elif-else:

```
score = 65

if score >= 80:
    print("Grade: Distinction")
elif score >= 60:
    print("Grade: Merit")
elif score >= 40:
    print("Grade: Pass")
else:
    print("Grade: Fail")
```



4.3 if-elif-else statement syntax

Example using if-elif-else:

```
score = 65

if score >= 80:
    print("Grade: Distinction")
elif score >= 60:
    print("Grade: Merit")
elif score >= 40:
    print("Grade: Pass")
else:
    print("Grade: Fail")
```

With score = 65, this outputs:

Grade: Merit

Try changing score and observe which branch runs:

- score = 90 → **Distinction**
- score = 70 → **Merit**
- score = 45 → **Pass**
- score = 30 → **Fail**



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5. Common Syntax Errors

As you write conditional statements, you will encounter Syntax Errors. Here are some common ones to watch out for.



5. Common Syntax Errors

As you write conditional statements, you will encounter Syntax Errors. Here are some common ones to watch out for.

Learning tip: Deliberately introduce these errors in VS Code, read the error message, and fix them. The more errors you encounter and fix, the faster you will recognise them in your own code.



5.1 Missing indentation

Problem — body of `if` not indented:

```
age = 25
if age >= 18:
print("You are an adult.")
print("You can vote.")
```

IndentationError: expected an indented block



5.1 Missing indentation

Problem — body of `if` not indented:

```
age = 25
if age >= 18:
print("You are an adult.")
print("You can vote.")
```

`IndentationError: expected an indented block`

Fix — indent the body consistently:

```
age = 25
if age >= 18:
    print("You are an adult.")
    print("You can vote.")
```

Python uses indentation to define code blocks. ✓



5.2 else with a condition

Problem — adding a condition to else:

```
score = 65
if score >= 60:
    print("Pass")
else score < 60:
    print("Fail")
```

SyntaxError: invalid syntax



5.2 else with a condition

Problem — adding a condition to else:

```
score = 65
if score >= 60:
    print("Pass")
else score < 60:
    print("Fail")
```

SyntaxError: invalid syntax

Fix — use `elif` when you need a condition, or remove it from `else`:

```
score = 65
if score >= 60:
    print("Pass")
elif score < 60:      # elif has a condition
    print("Fail")

# OR simply:
if score >= 60:
    print("Pass")
else:                  # else has no condition
    print("Fail")
```



5.3 elif without a matching if

Problem — elif indented inside the if body:

```
score = 65
if score >= 80:
    print("Distinction")
    elif score >= 60:
        print("Merit")
```

SyntaxError: invalid syntax

elif must be at the **same** indentation level as its if.



5.3 elif without a matching if

Problem — elif indented inside the if body:

```
score = 65
if score >= 80:
    print("Distinction")
    elif score >= 60:
        print("Merit")
```

SyntaxError: invalid syntax

elif must be at the **same** indentation level as its if.

Fix — align elif with if:

```
score = 65
if score >= 80:
    print("Distinction")
elif score >= 60:
    print("Merit")
elif score >= 40:
    print("Pass")
else:
    print("Fail")
```

if, elif, and else must all share the same indentation level. ✓



Thanks for Watching - Any questions?

